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Chapter 1

Getting Started



Prerequisites

Please note that System 21 Explorer supports only the configuration detailed separately on the latest System 21 Configuration Information Sheet issued by JBA Software Products Limited, although individual configurations can be agreed by or with clients and JBA Branches for local support of the product.

It is assumed that you are familiar with the standard elements of the Microsoft Windows interface, such as the controls for opening and closing windows, scroll bars, buttons and icons. However, help is included for some of the less well-known Windows terms and techniques.



Tip: For more information about Windows you should consult the Microsoft Windows documentation.

Opening And Closing Explorer

Opening

To open the JBA applications program called Explorer, doubleclick on JBA System 21 Explorer in your program list. Explorer immediately displays the workspace for you to start using Explorer.



Note: Logging on is not the first activity you have to perform in System 21 Explorer. You logon to the system only when you start an activity. Not all activities may be connected to the same host system so you may have to logon more than once depending on which activities you start. Please refer to the Application Server Settings Window. You can also force a logon using this toolbar button.



Tip: Online Help is available within the software itself as an option on the main menu.

Closing

You should exit all activities or applications and end any host sessions before closing Explorer, so that no window is left open or iconised on the workspace. If a process is still running at the server this may lead to data loss. An application or activity has been exited when the window that contains it is closed.

To close Explorer use the normal Windows functions to close the program, for example select Exit from the File Menu on the main menu bar.

If you have made any changes to a Role Menu Design then Explorer will prompt you to save those changes.

What Is Explorer?

Explorer provides a single point of access to JBA System 21 applications and to those applications that run under Microsoft Windows.

Applications are launched from a series of Role Menus, designed to reflect the activities performed by the people within the organisation. For example there could be one Role Menu for all the Sales Order Clerks, another one for the Inventory Clerks and so on.

There are advanced facilities, as follows, that are designed for a System Administrator, and can be switched on and off:

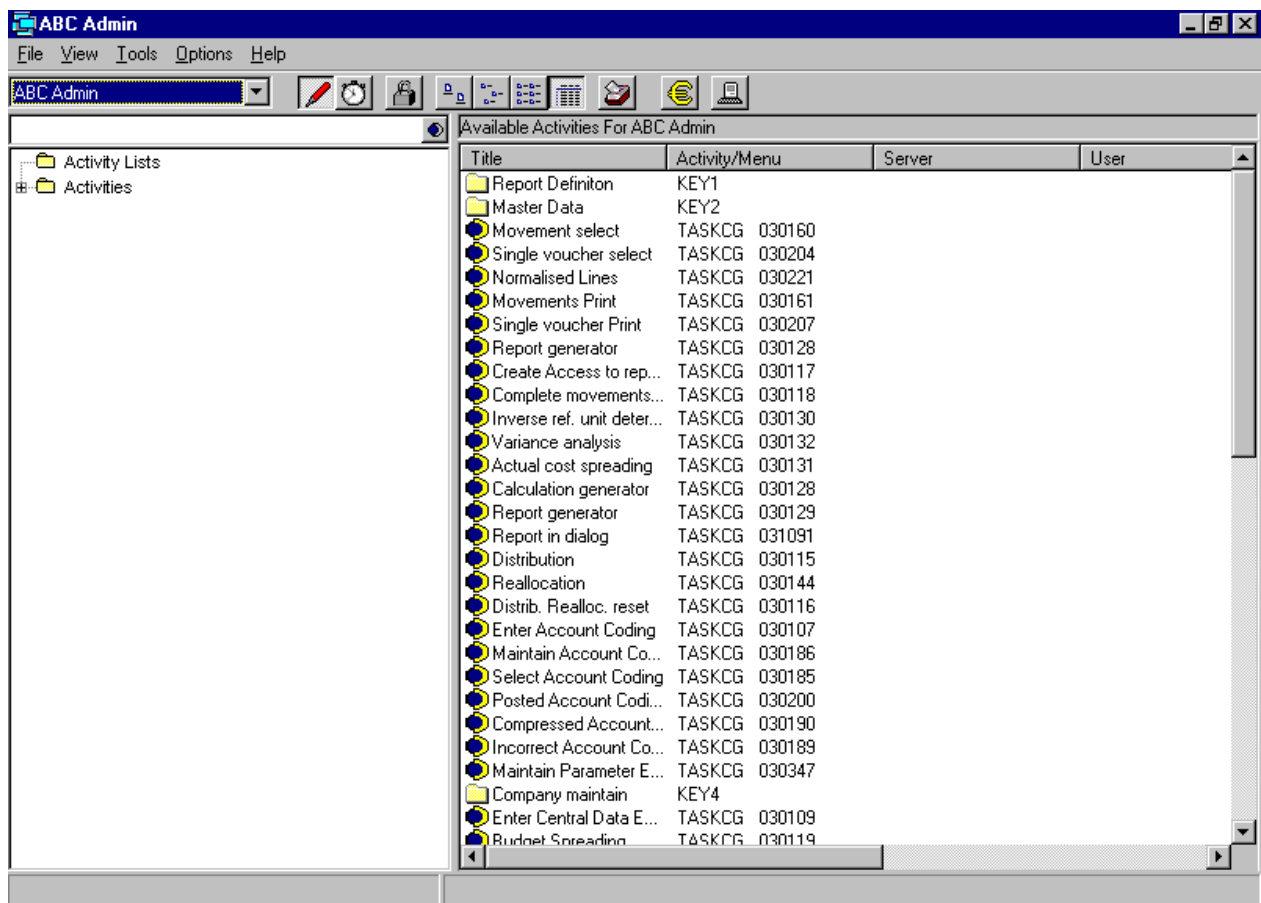
- Role Menu Designer enables you to design Role Menus to tailor your system to meet your business needs, so that individual users can be screened from sensitive applications.
- Explorer Designer enables you to reformat the application windows.
- System Configuration enables you to configure the system for the users.
- User Role Maintenance enables you maintain a list of users in the database and a list of authorised Role Menus for each user.
- Action Tracker enables you to view the current status of any Business Object on your database. You may also launch a pending Business Object.
- Document Viewer enables you to maintain a database of documents which can then be linked to System 21 Application Windows, Elemental Activities or third-party programs.
- Window Recognition enables you to fix minor screen issues where a pop up window in the application software appears incorrectly.
- Currency Conversion enables you to display a tooltip with currency conversion calculations and results for any Application Window value field.
- Email Server Agent enables you to forward email messages generated by the Work Management engine. It is designed to run unattended on a network server rather than a user's machine.

This Is What You See First

When you open Explorer you straightaway see many of the screen elements which you need to construct your business system. You see these elements in this order, starting from the top of the screen: Title Bar; Main Menu Bar; Toolbar; Display Area; Status Bar.

There are more Explorer features which you cannot see at first: context sensitive pop up menus, Explorer windows, application windows and error messages. You will use these when you start using and designing your Role Menus.

There are also further menus: System Configuration Menu, Designer Menu, User Role Maintenance Menu and Action Tracker Menu. Please refer to More Explorer Features.



Title Bar



This is at the top of the screen and tells you which Role Menu is currently active.

Main Menu Bar

There are five options: File, View, Tools, Options and Help menus. They are standard Windows drop down menus.



Tip: There is a separate Help section where each menu on the Menu Bar is explained in detail.

Toolbar



If you have not seen Explorer before then some of the buttons on this toolbar will be new to you.



Note: Your System Administrator determines which of these buttons are available to you.



Tip: It is worth taking the time to familiarise yourself with these before you start. There is a separate Help section where each button on the Toolbar is explained in detail.

Display Area

The Explorer display area is the area below the toolbar.

It is divided into two parts:

- Application Browser area on the left
- Role Activity Area on the right.



Tip: Both right and left parts of the Display Area are displayed only when the Role Menu Designer is enabled. When the Role Menu Designer is not enabled then the Application Browser area is not displayed and the right hand Role Activity Area is expanded to fill the width of the window. Click the Role Menu Designer button on the toolbar to toggle between Role Menu Designer mode and User mode.

Application Browser Area



Note: This area only displays if you have the Role Menu Designer Enabled.

This tree structure represents the logical structure of the application menus on the System 21 database. You can double click on any of the application activities in order to activate them. There are also Activity Lists.

At the top of the Application Browser area is a box where you can either start an Activity using the Shortcut Code or enter some text to display only those activities which had that text in the description. You need to click the button to change the field between the two uses.

By default, this box is set up to start an Activity using the Shortcut code, that is the button displays the activity icon:

For example, enter 1/OEP to run Transcriptional Order Entry.



Tip: If the button is displaying the wrong icon, just click the button. This toggles the display between the two icons.

To search for all activities containing specified text, first click the button, so it displays the search icon, then enter the search text:

For example, if you enter the word Sales then Explorer would display only those activities which had the word Sales in the description.

Role Activity Area

The drop down list box on the Explorer Toolbar displays the currently active Role selected and the Role Activity Area of the window displays all the activities which have been assigned to that Role. You can double click on any of the application activities in order to activate them. At the top of the Role Activity Area is a box containing the title of the currently selected menu. For example it might say: Available activities for the Order Entry Clerk.

The person who designs the Role Menus selects activities from the Application Browser area and drags them into the Role Activity Area.



Note: When the Action List is enabled, by using the Action List button on the Explorer toolbar, the Role Activity Area is contracted so that the Action List can be displayed at the bottom.

Status Bar



The Status Bar is the area at the bottom of the screen, and is split into two sections:

- The first section is not used.
- The second section shows progress messages, alerting you to System activity.

More Explorer Features

These are important features but they are not immediately obvious when you first start to use Explorer.

Context Sensitive Pop Up Menus



Tip: These are an important part of Explorer. It's worth experimenting to get used to them.

Just as for standard Windows 95 or Windows NT applications, Explorer supplies you with useful context sensitive pop up menus.

When you are in the Application Browser Area there is a pop up menu which you can display using the right mouse button. When you click on an activity the Application Browser Area Pop Up Menu is displayed.

When you are in the Role Activity Area there are two types of pop up menus which you can display using the right mouse button.

- When you click with the right mouse button on an activity then the Role Activity Area Pop Up Menu is displayed.
- When you click with the right mouse button on a blank space then the Role Activity Space Area Pop Up Menu is displayed.

Explorer Windows



Note: These are windows which enable you to exploit the features which Explorer has to offer. For example: The Preferences Window.

You can display the Explorer windows in several ways:

- By selecting options from the Main Menu Bar.
- By selecting options from the context sensitive pop up menus.



Tip: See the separate Help section where all the fields and buttons on each Window are explained in detail.

Application Windows



*Note: These are the JBA System 21 windows.
This could be, for example, an Order Entry
window.*

Each time you activate an activity the system starts a new session. The session number is displayed on the Status Bar. Each new session is displayed as a new window. When the system detects a new window, it centres it on the screen on top of any existing windows.

You can change this by clicking and dragging the windows to separate the overlapping windows. You can use the buttons at the top right hand side of a window to minimise, maximise or close the window.

You can have a maximum of eight windows open, dependent on the system resources available.

Asset maintenance

FA100 UK Demonstration Company User S21TST01 16/04/97 9:32:58

Asset Maintenance Selection

Enter : Asset? Maintain Dependents ...

Based on? In Company

or : Select from :

Analysis Type .?

Code? to &

and from

Analysis Type .?

Code? to &

F3:Exit F4:Prompt

Designer



Warning: Designer is intended for the System Administrator only.



Note: You can access the Designer Menu only if the Designer field, in the Preferences Window, has been checked. If the Designer field in the Preferences Window is disabled then contact your System Administrator who may want to reset permissions for you.

This enables the System Administrator to tailor the System 21 application window display for the System 21 user.

You can access Designer by using the Designer button on the toolbar. However this button may not always be available to you. When you start an activity the Designer button is displayed on the toolbar provided that:

- The window is not a Visual Component.
- The Designer field, in the Preferences Window, has been checked.
- There is only one active session. If you start a second session the Designer button becomes automatically disabled.
- The host screen contains a magic number.



Tip: Please refer to the separate help section called Explorer Designer.

System Configuration



Warning: System Configuration is intended for the System Administrator only.



Note: You can access the System Configuration Menu by using the System Configuration button on the Preferences Window. If this button is also disabled then contact your System Administrator who may want to reset permissions for you.

This enables the System Administrator to configure the options available to the Explorer user.

If you install JBA's Administration Tools product then System Configuration is displayed as a separate option in your Program List, alongside JBA System 21 Explorer.



Tip: Please refer to the separate help section called Explorer System Configuration.

User Role Maintenance



Warning: User Role Maintenance is intended for the System Administrator only.

This enables the System Administrator to:

- Maintain a list of users in the database.
- Maintain a list of authorised Role Menus for each user.



Note: You access User Role Maintenance from your JBA System 21 program list. You cannot gain access from within Explorer. User Role Maintenance is installed as part of JBA's Administration Tools product.



Tip: Please refer to the separate help section called Explorer User Role Maintenance.

Action Tracker



Warning: Action Tracker is intended for the System Administrator only.

This enables the System Administrator to view the current status of any Business Object on your database. You may also launch a pending Business Object.



Tip: Please refer to the separate help section called Explorer Action Tracker.

Document Viewer



Warning: Document Viewer is intended for the System Administrator only.

This enables the System Administrator to maintain a database of documents which can then be linked to System 21 Application Windows, Elemental Activities or third-party programs. For example you could use this facility to display company procedures at the start of an application or display catalogue photographs alongside product details.



Tip: Please refer to the separate help section called Document Viewer.

Window Recognition



Warning: Window Recognition is intended for the System Administrator only.

Window Recognition enables the System Administrator to fix minor screen issues where a pop up window in the application software appears incorrectly.

When a window displays incorrectly, the Window Recognition Utility determines whether there is an alternative to the pop up recognition algorithm used by Explorer. It stores details of magic numbers and window co-ordinates in a text file. This file is then loaded by the emulator at runtime and used to process the screens correctly.

Window Recognition is delivered with Explorer as part of Administration Tools. Please refer to the Technical Information Help file for more information about installing.



Tip: Please refer to the separate help section called Window Recognition.

Windows Terms And Techniques

It is assumed that you are familiar with the standard elements of the Windows interface such as the controls for opening and closing windows, scroll bars, buttons and icons. However, here is some information about some of the less well known ones.



Tip: For more information about Windows you should consult the Windows documentation.

Spin Button



A Spin Button is a control consisting of two arrows, one pointing upward and one pointing down, usually associated with a field containing numeric characters.

When the upward pointing arrow is selected the associated numeric field is incremented; when the downward arrow is selected the associated numeric field is decremented.

Option Button Group

- ☒ **None**
- ☐ **Description**
- ☐ **Variable Field**

Option button groups represent a group of mutually exclusive options. You can select only one option at a time, and if you already have one option selected your current selection replaces it. The selected option button is coloured in the centre.

Option Buttons are sometimes called Radio Buttons.

Check Box



A check box presents non exclusive options - you can select as many check box options as needed. When a check box is selected a cross appears in it and the function it is associated with is enabled.

Drop Down List



A drop down list appears initially as a rectangular box containing the current selection. When you select the down arrow in the square box at the right a list of available choices appears. If there are more items than can fit in the box, scroll bars are provided.

List View

Name	Value	Type
Names 1	10	String
Names 2	20	String
Names 3	30	Integer

A list view is a box containing several lists in columns. You can scroll up and down the list to view it. You cannot edit the details in the list directly. Instead you select a row and the details for that row are displayed in fields above.

Grid Box

A grid box is a JBA listing and viewing tool.

Error Messages

Error messages are displayed in separate windows.



Note: You will not be able to continue input until you clear the error message. In most cases this means clicking the OK button.